

Φλέγων ὁ Τραλλιανός

Phlegon of Tralles on Marvels and the Olympic Games

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Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)
Format: Συναγωγή [Collection](#)

Phlegon of Tralles was a Greek writer of the 2nd century CE and a freedman of the emperor Hadrian, originating from the city of Tralles in Lydia. His position as an imperial freedman places him within the network of educated Greek intellectuals serving the Roman imperial court.

His extant work, surviving in fragments, consists primarily of compilations. These include **On Marvels**, a paradoxographical collection of incredible stories about monsters, ghosts, and hermaphrodites; the **Olympiads**, a chronological history from 776 BCE to 137–141 CE; and **On Long-Lived Persons**, a catalog of individuals who achieved extreme old age.

Phlegon is a significant representative of imperial-era paradoxography. His **On Marvels** is a key source for ancient conceptions of the fantastic, while his **Olympiads** provided a chronological framework utilized by later historians like Eusebius. He exemplifies the cultural output of Greek intellectuals integrated into the Roman administrative system.

Works (3)

- Περὶ θαυμάτων · [On Marvels](#) · 65 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα · [On the Olympic Games](#) · 63 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 4 passages